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The other critical area of focus is cyber, which, with ubiquitous digitisation, becomes vulnerable to more risks. We work across a broad spectrum, especially with emerging sectors such as semiconductors and space, where we focus on growth by bringing investments into the country, while enhancing capabilities built within India.

Besides these tech-driven sectors, agriculture or ag-ritech is another priority sector. We are working with farmers and artisans to improve their productivity and reach, thereby servicing both ends of the spectrum.

**Q: Is India on the cusp of a transformation when it comes to its capacity as a manufacturing destination?**

**A:** Absolutely. As I talk to clients, one of the prevailing topics I often hear is the 'China+1' strategy wherein companies believe they must move and diversify their supply chains. It is not that everything is moving to India—but we see a significant uptick, especially where scale is required. Besides China, no other country in the world can match the scale that India can offer.

The advent of smart manufacturing is another driver. The convergence of software, electronics, and manufacturing expertise has created a unique opportunity for India. The ability to manufacture efficiently, more digitally, in smart factories, and at scale is key to this opportunity. Many companies from Japan, the US and Europe are moving their manufacturing operations into India, which indicates a definite and ongoing shift.

The PLI (production-linked incentive) scheme has helped and is playing a critical role. We have a huge domestic consumption base, and we are reducing our dependence on export markets. It is my dream to see trade fostering economic ties within South Asia, the Middle East, and Africa. We are talking about creating a global market with close to 3-3.5 billion people, with the potential to grow over the next five to 10 years. Trade in this area will be quite phenomenal.

**Q: Are Indian companies shaping up for the AI challenge?**

**A:** Definitely, we see a lot more interest. Three topics